

6 Becoming a Husband

Biblical Roles - Why?

To the woman he said, “I will make your pains in childbearing very severe; with painful labor you will give birth to children. Your desire will be for your husband, and he will rule over you.” To Adam he said, “Because you listened to your wife and ate fruit from the tree about which I commanded you, ‘You must not eat from it,’ ”Cursed is the ground because of you; through painful toil you will eat food from it all the days of your life. It will produce thorns and thistles for you, and you will eat the plants of the field. By the sweat of your brow you will eat your food until you return to the ground, since from it you were taken; for dust you are and to dust you will return.” Genesis 3

Relationships between Men and Women

	Created	Cursed	Redeemed
Woman	Helper Suitable	Desire husband's role	Submitted
Man	Exercise Dominion	Lord it over wife	Self-sacrifice
Marriage	Be Fruitful and Multiply		Demonstrate Christ+Church

Be filled with the Spirit

Fulfilling our biblical roles in marriage requires being filled with the Spirit

Eph 5:18-21: And do not get drunk with wine, for that is dissipation, but be filled with the Spirit, speaking to one another in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing and making melody with your heart to the LORD; always giving thanks for all things in the name of our LORD Jesus Christ to God, even the Father; and be subject to one another in the fear of Christ.

Filled with the Spirit

- New creation
- Trusting/Honoring Good
- Strengthened in his power
- Not ruled by worldly desire

Relational results of being filled with the Spirit

- Speaking in psalms
- Singing/making melody
- Giving thanks
- Being subject to one another in the fear of Christ

Biblical relationship

Eph 5:25-33 Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ also loved the church and gave himself up for her, so that He might sanctify her, having cleansed her by the washing of water with the word, that He might present to Himself the church in all her glory, having no spot or wrinkle or any such thing; but that she would be holy and blameless. So husbands ought also to love their own wives as their own bodies. He who loves his own wife loves himself; for no one ever hated his own flesh, but nourishes and cherishes it, just as Christ also does the church, because we are members of His body. For this reason a man shall leave his father and mother and shall be joined to his wife, and the two shall become one flesh. This mystery is great; but I am speaking with reference to Christ and the church. Nevertheless, each individual among you also is to love his own wife even as himself, and the wife must see to it that she respects her husband.

Men are called to lead as Christ led the church (p107)

John 10:11 I am the Good Shepherd (who lays down his life

Heb 12:2 For the joy set before Him endured the cross, despising the shame

Col 3:19 Husbands love your wives and do not be embittered against them

- Joyful sacrifice
- Speaking truth in love
- Praying for his wife
- Confront wife's sinfulness in a gracious way

Men are called to nourish and cherish (as their own bodies) p 111

“For no one ever hated his own flesh, but nourishes and cherishes it” (Eph. 5:29).

Men are called to understanding and showing honor p 112

Husbands, in the same way be considerate as you live with your wives, and treat them with respect as the weaker partner and as heirs with you of the gracious gift of life, so that nothing will hinder your prayers. (1Pe 3:7)

Weaker vessel:

- Submission places women in a vulnerable position (weakness)
- Woman’s role is different/distinct (suitable helper): Thoughts and reactions will be different
- Physical delicacy
- Susceptibility to error

Fellow heirs - recognize the ways in which God speaks to and through your spouse (spiritual antennae)

To ponder: In your coming marriage, are you likely to rely upon the Spirit and his strength or on your own strength?

Pro Tip: Living out biblical roles of husband and wife requires risk and vulnerability.

So when a husband is called to love his wife as Christ loved the church, he is called to
109

Leaving Parents p 118

For this reason a man shall leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife, and the two shall become one flesh. . . . So they are no longer two, but one flesh. What therefore God has joined together, let no man separate. (Matt. 19:5–6)

The instruction for a son to honor his father and mother also changes from a call to obey and

Chapter 6 questions

What is your view of biblical headship? (ask *both*)

How did you see headship and submission lived out in your home growing up?

Share about a few men who were key examples for you growing up—for better or for worse. How did they treat the women in their lives? What did you see in them and learn from them?

Are there ways in which you anticipate it will be difficult to leave your parents?

How do you anticipate your relationship with your parents will change after you get married?
